

OM NAMAH SHIVAYA | JAI MUKTINATH | OM MANI PADME HUM

NEPAL MOTORCYCLE PILGRIMAGE

Muktinath Dham & Pashupatinath Temple

Solo Moto Yatra — 2027

Mumbai → Bihar → Raxaul Border → Kathmandu → Pokhara → Muktinath → Return

ROUTE

Mumbai (Start) → Bihar (Home Visit) → Raxaul (Border) → Birgunj → Kathmandu → Pokhara → Jomsom → Muktinath → Chitwan → Lumbini → Birgunj → Bihar → Mumbai

Full Name	Samaranjan Pankajkumar Manjhi (27 Years Male Solo Rider)
Home State	Bihar (Originally) Current City: Mumbai, Maharashtra
Travel Style	Solo Pilgrim + Adventure Biker Budget Traveller
Primary Temples	Muktinath Dham (Mustang, Nepal) + Pashupatinath Temple (Kathmandu)
Bike	Royal Enfield Himalayan / Any RE with valid RC + DL
Route Type	Mumbai → Bihar (train with bike) → Raxaul Border → Nepal by Road
Total Duration	20 Days (15 Days Active + 5 Days Buffer)
Best Month 2027	October 2027 (Oct 1–20) — Less Crowded, Clear Skies, Post-Monsoon
Budget	Rs.500–1,200/night Rs.250–400/day food NPR 150/day bike permit
Stay Preference	Dharamshalas / Budget Guesthouses — Walk-in preferred

Har Har Mahadev | Om Namah Shivaya | Jai Muktinath Bhagwan

BEST TIME TO VISIT — 2027 RECOMMENDATION

For a solo motorcycle rider targeting less-crowded conditions, clear mountain roads, and excellent Himalayan visibility, **October 2027 (Oct 1–20)** is the ideal window. Post-Monsoon Autumn season — rain has washed air clean, skies are crystal clear, mountain views at their best, and crowds significantly lower than peak October-end when festival season brings a huge influx of pilgrims.

Season	Months	Road Condition	Crowd Level	Verdict
Post-Monsoon Autumn (RECOMMENDED)	Oct 1–20	Excellent — roads dry & clear after monsoon	Low to Medium	BEST for solo biker
Peak Autumn	Oct 20–Nov	Good — clear roads	HIGH (festivals)	Avoid if possible
Spring	Mar–May	Good — pleasant temperatures	Medium–High	Good 2nd choice
Winter	Dec–Feb	RISKY — Muktinath road may close due to snow	Very Low	Avoid for biker
Monsoon	Jun–Sep	BAD — landslides, floods on mountain roads	Low	DO NOT go by bike

NOTE: Muktinath is at 3,710m altitude. The road from Jomsom to Muktinath is an unpaved mountain track that can be blocked Nov–Feb due to snowfall. Oct 1–20 gives dry roads, zero snow risk, post-monsoon clear skies, and lower crowds before the Dashain/Tihar festival rush begins.

MASTER TRIP OVERVIEW — 20 DAYS

Day	Leg	Mode	Key Stop / Activity	Stay
1	Mumbai → Train (with bike)	Train	Board train to Bihar — overnight journey with bike as parcel	Train
2	Arrive Bihar — Rest	—	Home / Family time in Bihar. Collect bike from parcel office.	Bihar Home
3	Bihar → Raxaul Border	Motorcycle	Ride to Raxaul, cross into Birgunj, Nepal. Bhansar permit.	Birgunj, Nepal
4	Birgunj → Kathmandu	Motorcycle	Prithvi Highway (120 km). Arrive Kathmandu. Evening Pashupatinath.	Kathmandu
5	Kathmandu Sightseeing	Motorcycle + Walk	Pashupatinath, Boudhanath, Swayambhunath, Bhaktapur, Patan	Kathmandu
6	Kathmandu → Pokhara	Motorcycle	Prithvi Highway 200 km. Arrive Pokhara. Phewa Lake evening.	Pokhara
7	Pokhara Sightseeing	Motorcycle + Walk	Sarangkot sunrise, Fewa Lake, Davis Falls, World Peace Pagoda	Pokhara
8	Pokhara → Beni → Tatopani	Motorcycle	Enter Annapurna zone. Scenic gorge road. Hot springs at Tatopani.	Tatopani / Ghasa
9	Tatopani → Marpha → Jomsom	Motorcycle	Kali Gandaki gorge. Marpha apple town. Arrive Jomsom.	Jomsom
10	Jomsom → MUKTINATH + Kagbeni	Motorcycle	MUKTINATH DHAM DARSHAN — 108 sacred sprouts. Kagbeni village.	Muktinath / Jomsom
11	Buffer / Extra Muktinath Day	—	Rest & acclimatize OR explore Mustang area further.	Jomsom

Day	Leg	Mode	Key Stop / Activity	Stay
12	Jomsom → Pokhara (Return)	Motorcycle	Return ride via same route. Option: Ghorepani detour.	Pokhara
13	Pokhara → Chitwan	Motorcycle	Chitwan National Park — jungle safari, wildlife.	Chitwan
14	Chitwan → Lumbini	Motorcycle	Lumbini — Lord Buddha's Birthplace. Maya Devi Temple.	Lumbini
15	Lumbini → Birgunj → Bihar	Motorcycle	Cross back at Raxaul/Sunauli border. Arrive Bihar.	Bihar Home
16–17	Bihar — Rest + Buffer	—	Rest, bike service check, family time.	Bihar Home
18	Bihar → Mumbai (Train)	Train (with bike)	Ship bike as parcel. Board train back to Mumbai.	Train
19	Arrive Mumbai	—	Trip Complete — All temples visited!	Mumbai
20	Buffer Day	—	Emergency buffer / rest day. Use if any day was delayed.	—

NOTE: Days 11, 16–17, and 20 are buffer days — use them if weather, road conditions, or extra temple time is needed. Bihar serves as a natural stopover both on the way in and out. Muktinath road from Jomsom is 14 km of mountain track — well manageable on RE Himalayan.

PRE-DEPARTURE: TRANSPORTING BIKE FROM MUMBAI TO BIHAR BY TRAIN

Your home is near Banka District, Bihar. Banka is on the Bhagalpur–Sahibganj rail line. Nearest stations: Banka (BNKA) ~5 km, Jamui (JMU) ~30 km. Recommended: book bike parcel to Banka or Bhagalpur (BHP, ~45 km from Banka). This section is updated with Banka-specific train options.

Step	Action	Details / Notes (Banka-specific)
1	Drain petrol to near-empty	Indian Railways rule — tank must be less than 1/4 full. Drain at a petrol station before going to the parcel office.
2	Visit railway parcel office in advance	Go 2–3 days BEFORE your journey date — Mumbai LTT / CST parcel office. For return, visit Banka or Bhagalpur station parcel office on arrival.
3	Fill parcel consignment form	Provide original RC copy + Aadhaar / Voter ID. Staff will weigh the bike. Pay shipping charge at counter. Collect pink receipt — keep it safe.
4	Bike shipping cost (approximate)	Mumbai LTT → Banka (BNKA): Rs.2,500–3,800 Mumbai LTT → Bhagalpur (BHP): Rs.2,500–3,800 Rates depend on train and exact distance. Ask parcel counter for current rates.
5	Best trains from Mumbai for Banka / Bhagalpur	11063 LTT–JAYNAGAR EXPRESS (LTT → Banka/Bhagalpur — direct, stops at Banka) 12325 KOAA–RAJYA RANI EXPRESS (check stops) 13201 LTT–RAJENDRANAGAR EXPRESS (LTT → Patna, then onward) Book SL class for yourself on the same train as bike parcel.
6	Collect bike at destination	Go to Banka / Bhagalpur station parcel office with consignment receipt + ID. Bike is usually available 2–6 hrs after train arrives. If parcel arrives at Bhagalpur, ride ~45 km to Banka home.
7	Ride Banka → Raxaul border (Day 3)	Distance: ~320–340 km Time: 6–7 hrs Route: Banka → Munger → Begusarai → Muzaffarpur → Motihari → Raxaul Via NH-333B / NH-28 → NH-27 → NH-527D IMPORTANT: Start by 05:00 AM — earlier than the original plan. See updated Day 3 itinerary below.

NOTE: Return journey: Ship the bike back from Banka/Bhagalpur to Mumbai LTT the same way. Book the return parcel slot before you leave Mumbai — confirm at Banka/Bhagalpur station parcel office on arrival. Service your bike fully before the return parcel shipment.

BANKA → RAXAUL BORDER — Detailed Route Breakdown (Day 3, ~320 km)

Segment	Distance	Road / Highway	Notes
Banka → Munger	~55 km	NH-333B	Exit Banka district. Road is decent. Fill fuel in Munger — good petrol pumps.
Munger → Begusarai	~50 km	NH-28 / State Hwy	Cross the Ganga via Munger–Khagaria road or NH-28. Begusarai is an industrial town — good facilities.
Begusarai → Muzaffarpur	~90 km	NH-28 → NH-27	Good 2-lane highway. Chai break at Hajipur or Muzaffarpur. NH-27 is well-maintained.
Muzaffarpur → Motihari	~70 km	NH-27	Good highway. Motihari is East Champaran HQ — last major fuel + food stop before Raxaul.
Motihari → Raxaul Border	~55 km	NH-527D	2-lane highway, manageable traffic. This is the official Nepal border highway — well-known route.

■ Banka is ~320 km from Raxaul — significantly further than the original itinerary assumed (~100–200 km). Start Day 3 at 05:00 AM sharp. Consider Option B (split into 2 days via Muzaffarpur overnight) if you prefer a relaxed pace — see updated Day 3 itinerary on the next page.

TWO OPTIONS FOR DAY 3 — Choose Based on Your Pace

Option	Plan	Day 3 End Point	Total Trip Days
Option A (Push Through)	Start 05:00 AM from Banka. Ride straight to Raxaul (~320 km, 6–7 hrs). Cross border. Ride Birgunj → Kathmandu (~120 km, 4–5 hrs). Arrive Kathmandu ~21:00–22:00. Long but doable.	Kathmandu (very late)	20 days (no change)
Option B (Recommended — Relaxed)	Start 05:00 AM from Banka. Ride to Muzaffarpur (~215 km, ~4 hrs). Overnight at Muzaffarpur (good hotels, Rs.500–900). Next morning: Muzaffarpur → Raxaul → Birgunj → Kathmandu (~295 km, ~7 hrs). Arrive Kathmandu at a comfortable hour.	Muzaffarpur (comfortable)	21 days (use 1 buffer day)

✓ **RECOMMENDATION:** Option B is safer and more enjoyable. You have 5 buffer days built in — using one for a Muzaffarpur overnight keeps the ride comfortable and you arrive in Kathmandu fresh on Day 4. Bihar roads need respect — 320 km in one go before a border crossing is tiring.

NOTE: Indian citizens do NOT need a visa for Nepal. Bhansar is now an online system (2026) — visit Nepal customs website, fill the form, upload RC + passport scans, pay NPR 150/day × planned days, print/save approval. This saves significant time at border. Surrender your Bhansar permit at exit — failure to do so can block future Nepal trips.

DOCUMENTS CHECKLIST — CONTINUED

C. TREKKING / PILGRIMAGE PERMITS (Muktinath / Annapurna Region)

Permit	Mandatory?	Fee (SAARC / Indian)	Where to get	When checked
ACAP (Annapurna Conservation Area Permit)	YES — non-negotiable. No ACAP = turned back at Nayapul/Birethanti checkpoint.	NPR 1,000–2,000 (SAARC rate — lower than foreign tourists)	Nepal Tourism Board (NTB) office, Kathmandu (Day 5 morning) OR Pokhara NTB office (Day 7). Carry 2 passport photos.	Nayapul/Birethanti entry gate + Tatopani checkpoint on Muktinath road
TIMS Card (Trekking Information Management System)	YES — required even for motorcycle ride to Muktinath (not just trekkers). Mandatory per 2025 Nepal Tourism Board enforcement.	NPR 300–600 (SAARC rate)	NTB / TAAN office in Kathmandu or Pokhara. Get same day as ACAP permit. Carry 2 passport photos + passport copy.	Conservation area checkpoints en route to Jomsom/Muktinath
RAP (Restricted Area Permit — Upper Mustang)	NOT required for this trip. Muktinath is in Lower Mustang — no RAP needed. RAP only if you go beyond Kagbeni toward Lo Manthang.	N/A (USD 500 if Upper Mustang — not in this itinerary)	N/A for this itinerary	N/A

■ **ACAP + TIMS must be collected BEFORE leaving Pokhara — they are NOT available on the Jomsom road. Day 5 morning in Kathmandu (NTB office, Pradarshani Marg) is the planned slot — already built into your itinerary. Carry them in your waterproof jacket pocket at all times.**

D. MASTER QUICK-REFERENCE CHECKLIST (Pack & Tick Before Departure)

	Document / Item	Your Status	Pack in
1	PASSPORT (Original)	✓ Have it	Jacket inner pocket (always on person)
2	VOTER ID — Original ECI card	✓ Have it	Waterproof document folder
3	DRIVING LICENCE (Class M)	✓ Have it	Jacket front pocket (quick access at checkpoints)
4	AADHAAR CARD	✓ Have it (India legs only)	Wallet / document folder
5	PAN CARD	✓ Have it (India legs only)	Wallet / document folder
6	RC — Registration Certificate (Original) Bike owner: Samaranjan Pankajkumar Manjhi	✓ Have it	Waterproof tank bag / document pouch
7	BIKE INSURANCE PAPERS (valid Oct 2027) Confirm Nepal endorsement with insurer	✓ Have it (verify Nepal coverage)	Waterproof tank bag with RC
8	PUC CERTIFICATE (valid Oct 2027)	✓ Renew if expiring before Oct 2027	Waterproof tank bag with RC
9	BHANSAR PERMIT (Nepal online — apply before travel) nepalcustoms.gov.np NPR 150/day	Apply 1 week before departure	Print + save PDF on phone. Jacket pocket.

DETAILED DAY-BY-DAY ITINERARY

DAYS 1–2 — MUMBAI → BANKA, BIHAR (Train with Bike Parcel)

Time / Day	Activity
Day 1 — Morning	Submit bike at railway parcel office at LTT / CST Mumbai. Drain fuel beforehand. Fill consignment form. Collect receipt. Book to Banka (BNKA) or Bhagalpur (BHP).
Day 1 — Evening	Board your train to Bihar. Recommended: 11063 LTT–JAYNAGAR EXPRESS (stops at Banka) or 13201 LTT–RAJENDRANAGAR EXPRESS (to Patna, then connect). SL class Rs.500–750.
Day 2 — Morning	Arrive Banka / Bhagalpur. Collect bike from parcel office with receipt + ID. If collected at Bhagalpur, ride ~45 km to Banka home. Check: tyre pressure, engine oil, chain lube, all fluids.
Day 2 — Rest	Rest at home. Final packing for Nepal trip. Double-check ALL documents. Keep RC, DL, Bhansar permit printout, ACAP permit in a single waterproof folder. Fill petrol to FULL tonight — Banka pumps are your last cheap Bihar fuel.

DAY 3 — BANKA → RAXAUL BORDER → BIRGUNJ (Option A — Push Through, 20-day plan)

Time	Activity
05:00 AM	EARLY START — essential for this long day. Full breakfast at home. Bike fully fuelled the night before. Wear full riding gear. Inform family of your route: Banka → Munger → Muzaffarpur → Motihari → Raxaul.
05:00–08:00	Banka → Munger → Begusarai (~105 km, ~3 hrs). NH-333B to Munger, then NH-28. Fill fuel at Munger — reliable pumps. Brief chai break.
08:00–10:30	Begusarai → Muzaffarpur (~90 km, ~2.5 hrs). NH-27. Good highway. SHORT BREAK at Muzaffarpur — chai, snack, stretch. Do not linger — long day ahead.
10:30–12:30	Muzaffarpur → Motihari (~70 km, ~2 hrs). NH-27. FILL FUEL at Motihari — last major Indian city before Raxaul. Have lunch here (Rs.100–200). Motihari is East Champaran HQ — good dhabas on the highway.
12:30–14:00	Motihari → Raxaul (~55 km, ~1.5 hrs). NH-527D. Border highway — straightforward. Reach Raxaul by 14:00.
14:00–15:00	RAXAUL BORDER — India side exit. Show RC + DL + Passport / Voter ID. Get exit stamp on passport. Cross into Birgunj (Nepal). Walk bike to Bhansar customs counter. Show online Bhansar permit + RC. Get entry stamp.
15:00–16:00	Birgunj — Exchange Rs.5,000 into NPR at border money changer (best rates here). Quick lunch / late chai if needed. Fill Nepal fuel.
16:00–20:00	Birgunj → Kathmandu (~120 km, ~4–5 hrs). Prithvi/Tribhuvan Highway. Road climbs through Chure Hills — scenic but requires focused riding. ARRIVE BEFORE DARK is important — aim to reach Kathmandu by 20:00–21:00.
20:00–21:00	Arrive Kathmandu. Check into guesthouse near Thamel (NPR 600–1,200/night). Park bike securely. Light dinner. Sleep — very long day behind you.

■ Option A is ~440 km total riding in one day (Banka → Raxaul + Birgunj → Kathmandu). This is achievable on a Royal Enfield Himalayan but physically demanding. Do NOT attempt if you are tired, unwell, or if weather is bad. Switch to Option B in that case.

DAY 3 (Option B — RECOMMENDED) — BANKA → MUZAFFARPUR overnight halt

Time	Activity
06:00 AM	Start from Banka home. Full breakfast. Bike fuelled. Today's target is Muzaffarpur only (~215 km) — a comfortable, relaxed ride.
06:00–10:00	Banka → Munger → Begusarai → Muzaffarpur (~215 km, ~4 hrs). NH-333B → NH-28 → NH-27. Good roads. Arrive Muzaffarpur by 10:00 AM.

Time	Activity
10:00 AM	Arrive Muzaffarpur. Check into a hotel / guesthouse (Rs.500–900/night — several options near NH-27 bypass). Rest, shower, eat a proper lunch.
Afternoon	Bike service check — tyre pressure, chain, oil, lights. Fill fuel to full. Rest and sleep early. Tomorrow is the border crossing day.

DAY 4 (Option B only) — MUZAFFARPUR → RAXAUL → BIRGUNJ → KATHMANDU

Time	Activity
06:00 AM	Start Muzaffarpur → Motihari → Raxaul (~125 km, ~2.5 hrs). NH-27 → NH-527D. Arrive Raxaul by 08:30 AM — border is fresh and uncrowded in the morning.
08:30–10:00	RAXAUL BORDER — India exit stamp. Cross into Birgunj Nepal. Bhansar customs — show permit + RC. Get Nepal entry stamp. Exchange currency. Fill Nepal fuel.
10:00–15:00	Birgunj → Kathmandu (~120 km, ~4–5 hrs). Prithvi Highway. Comfortable daytime ride. Arrive Kathmandu ~15:00.
15:00–17:00	Check into guesthouse (Thamel or Pashupatinath area, NPR 600–1,200). Park bike. Evening: explore Thamel market. Light dinner. Rest — Kathmandu sightseeing starts next day.

✓ Option B uses 1 buffer day for the Muzaffarpur overnight. You still arrive Kathmandu on schedule (Day 4 of 21 instead of Day 3 of 20). All subsequent days shift by +1 but the full itinerary remains intact. Birgunj → Kathmandu in daylight hours (10:00 AM start) is far more enjoyable than arriving at 21:00.

NOTE: The Birgunj–Kathmandu road climbs steadily through the Chure Hills — scenic but requiring careful riding on bends. Arrive before dark regardless of which option you choose. Petrol stations are available all along the route. Birgunj has ATMs — top up NPR cash here.

DETAILED DAY-BY-DAY ITINERARY

DAYS 1-2 — MUMBAI → BIHAR (Train with Bike Parcel)

Time / Day	Activity
Day 1 — Morning	Submit bike at railway parcel office at LTT / CST Mumbai. Drain fuel beforehand. Fill consignment form. Collect receipt.
Day 1 — Evening	Board your train to Bihar. Recommended: 12397 MAHABODHI EXPRESS (LTT → Gaya) or 12141 PATNA SF EXPRESS (LTT → Patna). SL class Rs.500-700.
Day 2 — Morning	Arrive Bihar home station. Collect bike from parcel office with receipt + ID. Check: tyre pressure, engine oil, chain lube, all fluids.
Day 2 — Rest	Rest at home. Final packing for Nepal trip. Double-check all documents. Keep RC, DL, Bhansar permit printout, ACAP permit in a single waterproof folder.

DAY 3 — BIHAR → RAXAUL BORDER → BIRGUNJ (Enter Nepal)

Time	Activity
06:00 AM	Early start from Bihar home. Light breakfast. Fill petrol to FULL — this is your last cheap Indian fuel before Nepal.
06:00-10:00	Ride to Raxaul border. Route: Bihar home → Motihari → Raxaul (~100-200 km depending on your district, 3-5 hrs). NH27 / NH527D highway — good road.
10:00-11:00	Reach Raxaul (India side). Indian customs exit — show RC + DL + Passport/Voter ID. Exit stamp on passport. Straightforward for Indian citizens.
11:00-12:00	Cross into Birgunj (Nepal side). Walk your bike to the Bhansar customs counter. Show your online Bhansar permit printout + RC. Pay any remaining fees. Get entry stamp.
12:00-13:00	Birgunj town — exchange Rs.5,000 into NPR at the border money changer (good rates here). Have lunch at a local restaurant (NPR 200-300 thali).
13:00	Start Birgunj → Kathmandu ride (120 km, ~4-5 hrs). Route: Birgunj → Pathlaiya → Hetauda → Naubise → Kathmandu (Prithvi/Tribhuvan Highway). Road climbs through scenic Chure hills.
18:00-19:00	Arrive Kathmandu. Check into guesthouse near Thamel or Pashupatinath area (NPR 600-1,200/night). Park bike safely in guesthouse courtyard or secure parking.
Evening	Light dinner near Thamel. Explore the famous Thamel market area on foot. Sleep early — long day tomorrow.

NOTE: The Birgunj-Kathmandu road climbs steadily through the Chure Hills — scenic but requires careful riding especially on bends. Arrive before dark. Petrol stations available all along the route. Birgunj has ATMs — top up NPR cash here.

DAY 4 — KATHMANDU: PASHUPATINATH DARSHAN + ARRIVAL SIGHTSEEING

Time	Activity
05:00 AM	PASHUPATINATH TEMPLE — Sacred Shiva temple on the banks of Bagmati River. Morning Aarti is at 5 AM — powerful spiritual atmosphere. Indian Hindus entry is FREE. Leave bike at parking outside.
07:00–08:00	Witness the sacred cremation ceremony on the Bagmati Ghats — a profound, humbling spiritual experience. Maintain respectful silence and appropriate distance.
09:00 AM	Breakfast near Pashupatinath — try Nepali sel roti (rice flour donuts) with tea. Rs.50–80.
10:00 AM	BOUDHANATH STUPA — largest stupa in Asia, UNESCO site (3 km from Pashupatinath). Circumambulate clockwise with the Buddhist monks. Entry NPR 400. Mesmerizing atmosphere.
12:00 PM	SWAYAMBHUNATH — Monkey Temple. Hilltop stupa with 360-degree Kathmandu valley view. 365 steps climb (or ride up the back road). Entry NPR 200. About 5 km from Boudhanath.
02:00 PM	Lunch in Thamel area — dal bhat thali NPR 200–350 (unlimited refills).
03:30 PM	KATHMANDU DURBAR SQUARE — Ancient royal palace complex, Kumari Ghar (living goddess), Taleju Temple. UNESCO site. Entry NPR 1,000. Allow 1.5–2 hrs.
05:30 PM	Thamel market — buy warm layering clothes for Muktinath (fleece, thermal inner) if you do not have them. Also stock up on energy bars, dry fruits, medicines.
07:00 PM	Dinner + sleep. Tomorrow is a full sightseeing + permit day.

DAY 5 — KATHMANDU: BHAKTAPUR + PATAN + ACAP PERMIT (Essential)

Time	Activity
08:00 AM	ACAP PERMIT — Visit Nepal Tourism Board (NTB) office, Pradarshani Marg, Kathmandu. Collect Annapurna Conservation Area Permit. Cost: NPR 3,000 (~Rs.1,860). This is MANDATORY for the Muktinath road. Carry 2 passport photos.
10:00 AM	BHAKTAPUR DURBAR SQUARE (13 km east, 30 min ride) — medieval city, best preserved ancient town in Nepal. 55-Window Palace, Nyatapola Temple (5-story pagoda), traditional potters square. UNESCO site. Entry NPR 1,800. Allow 2 hrs.
01:00 PM	PATAN (Lalitpur) DURBAR SQUARE (6 km south of Kathmandu) — Krishna Mandir, Golden Temple (Hiranya Varna Mahavihar), stunning stone architecture. UNESCO site. Entry NPR 1,000. Allow 1 hr.
03:00 PM	NAGARKOT (32 km east, 45 min ride) — hilltop viewpoint at 2,175m. Best Himalaya panorama around Kathmandu — Langtang, Ganesh Himal, Jugal range, and on clear days even Everest peak. Sunset here is spectacular.
06:00 PM	Return to Kathmandu. Check tyre pressure, chain lubrication, brake pads — important before the Pokhara highway ride tomorrow.
08:00 PM	Dinner at Thamel. Early sleep — Pokhara ride (200 km) is tomorrow morning.

NOTE: Bhaktapur and Patan are UNESCO World Heritage Sites that many visitors say are MORE beautiful than Kathmandu Durbar Square. Do not skip them. Nagarkot at sunset is highly recommended for the Himalayan panorama. Entry fees add up — keep NPR 5,000–6,000 for Kathmandu sights.

DAY 6 — KATHMANDU → POKHARA (200 km | ~5 hrs | Prithvi Highway)

Time	Activity
07:00 AM	Early breakfast + checkout. Fill fuel tank to full before leaving Kathmandu.
08:00 AM	Start riding Prithvi Highway (NH44) — Kathmandu → Pokhara, 200 km. Beautiful route running alongside the Trishuli River gorge through green hills.
10:00 AM	MANAKAMANA CABLE CAR stop (optional, ~90 km from Kathmandu) — 10-min cable car up to Manakamana Devi temple on a hilltop. Rs.500–600 return. Stunning valley view. Allow 1.5 hrs if you stop.
12:00 PM	Lunch stop at Abu Khaireni or Damauli town — good roadside dhabas. Dal bhat or thali.
14:00–15:00	Arrive Pokhara. Check into guesthouse near Lakeside (Fewa Lake) area (NPR 700–1,500/night). Park bike securely.
15:30 PM	Fewa Lake — hire a rowboat (NPR 300/hr) to Barahi Temple (island temple in middle of the lake). Annapurna range as backdrop — postcard view.
17:30 PM	Lakeside promenade walk. Watch the Annapurna range turn golden at sunset — Machhapuchhre (Fishtail) is the most dramatic peak.
19:00 PM	Dinner at Lakeside restaurant — try momos and dal bhat. Pokhara has good budget food everywhere.

DAY 7 — POKHARA SIGHTSEEING + ROUTE PREP FOR MUKTINATH ROAD

Time	Activity
05:00 AM	SARANGKOT HILL — 8 km ride up + short walk to the viewpoint. Best sunrise Himalaya panorama in Nepal. On clear days you see Annapurna I, Annapurna South, Machhapuchhre, Dhaulagiri, Hiunchuli all at once. Arrive 30 min before sunrise.
07:30 AM	Breakfast at Sarangkot dhaba — fresh tea + bread/eggs. The sunrise is worth the early start.
09:30 AM	DAVIS FALLS (Patale Chhango) + GUPTESHWOR MAHADEV CAVE — these two are adjacent (5 min walk between them). Davis Falls is a powerful waterfall that disappears underground. The cave inside has a natural Shiva lingam — sacred. Entry: Davis Falls NPR 50, Cave NPR 100.
11:30 AM	WORLD PEACE PAGODA (Shanti Stupa) — a 45 min walk up a hill path or ride up the back road. Gleaming white Buddhist stupa with 360-degree views of Pokhara city, Fewa Lake, and the Annapurna range. Free entry.
13:00 PM	Lunch at Lakeside. Buy extra dry fruits, energy bars, glucose biscuits for the Muktinath mountain road ahead.
14:30 PM	MAHENDRA CAVE — natural limestone cave with large bat colony inside. Interesting geological formations. Entry NPR 100–200.
15:30 PM	Bike preparation — Check and top up tyre pressure (slightly lower for mountain gravel roads). Inspect chain, brakes, headlight, horn. Fill fuel FULL — this is the last big city before the mountains.
16:30 PM	Buy extra warm layer if needed — Jomsom and Muktinath will be 5–12°C in October. Thermal inner + fleece + wind-proof outer.
20:00 PM	Early sleep — Day 8 starts at 6:30 AM. The mountain road to Tatopani is long and requires full energy.

NOTE: PARAGLIDING at Sarangkot, Pokhara is world-famous (Rs.3,000–4,000, 20–30 min flight over the lake and Himalayas) — highly recommended if budget allows, book Day 6 evening for Day 7 morning slot. Sarangkot sunrise + Fewa Lake sunset are the two non-negotiable Pokhara experiences.

DAY 8 — POKHARA → BENI → TATOPANI (185 km | ~5–6 hrs | Kali Gandaki Gorge Starts)

Time	Activity
06:30 AM	Early start — full fuel tank. Exit Pokhara south-west toward Baglung via Siddhartha / Baglung Highway.
08:00 AM	NAYAPUL / BIRETHANTI — entry checkpoint to Annapurna Conservation Area. Show your ACAP permit here. First stunning Himalayan scenery begins. The road hugs the Kali Gandaki river.
09:00 AM	BAGLUNG — small district town. Last comfortable fuel stop before Tatopani. Fill up here.
10:00 AM	BENI — district headquarters. Chai break. Bazaar. From here the road enters the Myagdi Gorge — it narrows and becomes more dramatic.
11:30 AM	Road through Myagdi Gorge — the road hugs the cliff face alongside the Kali Gandaki River far below. Spectacular scenery but requires focused riding. No rushing.
13:00 PM	TATOPANI (Hot Springs, 1,189m) — ESSENTIAL STOP. Natural geothermal hot spring pools alongside the Kali Gandaki. Entry NPR 200. Soak for 45–60 min — it heals tired muscles and is a spiritual experience too. Lunch here.
15:00 PM	Optional: Continue another 30 km to GHASA (1,850m) for better altitude acclimatization before Jomsom tomorrow. OR stay at Tatopani.
Evening	Stay at Tatopani or Ghasa guesthouse (NPR 400–800). Simple rooms, basic facilities. Dal bhat dinner. Sleep warm — temperature drops at night.

NOTE: Road from Beni onward is unpaved in stretches — rocky surface, occasional river crossings at low water points. Royal Enfield Himalayan handles this excellently. Ride conservatively — no rushing. Tatopani hot springs are therapeutic after the mountain riding. Do not skip them.

DAY 9 — TATOPANI/GHASA → MARPHA → JOMSOM (80–100 km | ~4–5 hrs | High Mountain)

Time	Activity
07:00 AM	Start EARLY — critical on this stretch. Kali Gandaki gorge afternoon winds (after 12 PM) can reach 60–80 km/h and make riding dangerous or impossible. Morning is always calm and safe.
08:30 AM	KALOPANI (2,530m) — stop here for the best view of DHAULAGIRI (8,167m — 7th highest mountain in the world) and ANNAPURNA I (8,091m — 10th highest). Both visible simultaneously from this village. Photos mandatory.
10:00 AM	MARPHA VILLAGE (2,670m) — famous UNESCO-listed ancient Thakali village known for apple orchards. Village lanes are immaculate white-washed alleys. Try fresh apple juice, apple brandy, apple jam. Stop 45 min.
11:30 AM	TUKUCHE village — another old trading post. Continue steadily toward Jomsom.
13:00 PM	Arrive JOMSOM (2,720m) — district headquarters of Mustang district. Check into guesthouse (NPR 500–1,200/night). Jomsom has electricity, ATM (sometimes unreliable), mobile signal.
14:00 PM	Rest and acclimatize at Jomsom. Drink plenty of water. Avoid alcohol tonight — altitude makes dehydration much worse.
15:00 PM	KAGBENI (8 km from Jomsom, 30 min ride) — ancient medieval village at the confluence of Kali Gandaki and Mustang rivers. Mud-brick fortress town, narrow lanes, ancient gumpa. Gateway to Upper Mustang (restricted area). Highly photogenic.
17:30 PM	Return to Jomsom before dusk. Do not ride after dark on mountain roads.
20:00 PM	Early dinner + sleep WARM. Night temperature in Jomsom in October: 5–8°C. Wear thermals.

NOTE: KALI GANDAKI AFTERNOON WINDS are legendary — locals call it the 'tunnel winds of Mustang.' They regularly reach 60–80 km/h from 12 PM onward. Always complete your riding in this valley by 12:30 PM at the latest. Keep helmet visor down. Jomsom has a small airport — helicopter evacuation is possible in genuine emergency.

DAY 10 — JOMSOM → MUKTINATH DHAM DARSHAN → KAGBENI (Sacred Pilgrimage Day)

Time	Activity
05:30 AM	Wake up. Warm up bike engine — cold morning at 2,720m altitude. Minimal breakfast. Wear full thermal layers.
06:30 AM	Ride Jomsom → Muktinath (14 km, ~45 min on rough mountain track, altitude rises to 3,710m). Ride carefully — loose gravel, some steep sections. RE Himalayan handles this perfectly.
07:15 AM	Arrive MUKTINATH DHAM (3,710m). Park bike at the entry. Leave rucksack secured on bike. Carry only your sling bag + dry change of clothes inside.
07:30 AM	MUKTIDHARA — 108 sacred water spouts arranged in a semicircle. Standing under all 108 (the water is ice-cold, fed by Himalayan snow melt) is the main ritual. Takes 20–30 min. Carry a dry change of clothes — you will be completely soaked.
08:30 AM	VISHNU TEMPLE (main sanctum) — Muktinath is one of only 108 Divya Desams of Lord Vishnu, and the ONLY one outside India. Ancient black stone Vishnu idol. Deep, quiet darshan.
09:30 AM	JWALA MAI TEMPLE — natural eternal flame (natural gas seeping from ground) combined with flowing water — this combination of fire and water at the same spot is unique in the world. Extremely sacred for both Hindus and Tibetan Buddhists.
10:30 AM	BUDDHIST GOMPA (monastery) — ancient Tibetan Buddhist monastery above the temple compound. Panoramic view of the Mustang valley and Himalayan peaks. Monks performing prayers.
12:00 PM	Sit quietly in the temple courtyard. Meditate or simply absorb the sacred energy. Muktinath at 3,710m, surrounded by snow peaks, is spiritually overwhelming.
13:00 PM	Begin descent back to Jomsom (14 km). Lunch at Jomsom.
14:30 PM	Return to KAGBENI (8 km) — explore the Black Kali Gandaki Temple and the ancient fortress walls. The afternoon light on the red-brown Mustang landscape is beautiful.
17:30 PM	Return Jomsom. CELEBRATE — you have completed the sacred Muktinath pilgrimage!
20:00 PM	Early sleep. Big return ride begins on Day 12.

NOTE: ALTITUDE TIPS at 3,710m: Drink 3–4 litres of water today. No alcohol the night before or day of. If you experience severe headache, vomiting, or confusion — descend immediately to Jomsom (lower altitude). Diamox (Acetazolamide) 250mg taken 24 hrs before ascent significantly helps. The 108 water spouts ritual is the most unique spiritual experience of this entire yatra — do not rush it despite the cold water.

DAY 11 — BUFFER / REST / EXTRA MUSTANG EXPLORATION (Jomsom Base)

Option	Details
REST DAY	Simply rest at Jomsom guesthouse. Eat well. Drink plenty of water. Let your body recover from 3,710m altitude. This is what the buffer day is for — use it if you feel any altitude effects.
MUKTINATH EXTRA	Return to Muktinath for a second, unhurried darshan. Early morning at the temple with no crowds is an unforgettable spiritual experience.
MUSTANG RIDE	Ride north to KAGBENI and beyond toward Chele if roads are open. The Upper Mustang landscape (called 'Moon Country') is otherworldly — brown desert Himalayas unlike anything else in Nepal.
LOCAL CULTURE	Spend time in Jomsom Bazaar. Talk to Thakali people (local community). Visit the small Mustang Museum in Jomsom (NPR 100). Buy authentic Tibetan Buddhist thanka paintings or singing bowls.

DAY 12 — JOMSOM → POKHARA (Return Ride ~180 km | ~5–6 hrs)

Time	Activity
06:30 AM	Start EARLY before Kali Gandaki winds pick up. Full fuel from Jomsom.
08:30 AM	Stop at MARPHA one last time — buy apple jam, dried apples, apple brandy as souvenirs and gifts for family.
10:00 AM	TATOPANI — optional quick soak in hot springs (30 min) if time allows. Otherwise continue.
12:00 PM	BENI — lunch stop. Last Kali Gandaki valley town.
14:00–15:00	Arrive Pokhara. Check into guesthouse near Lakeside (NPR 700–1,200).
Evening	Optional final sunset at Fewa Lake. Rest and pack for Chitwan tomorrow.

DAY 13 — POKHARA → CHITWAN NATIONAL PARK (120 km | ~3 hrs)

Time	Activity
08:00 AM	Breakfast + checkout. Ride Pokhara → Chitwan (Sauraha village, 120 km, good highway, ~3 hrs). Route: Pokhara → Prithvi Highway → Bharatpur → Sauraha.
11:00 AM	Arrive SAURAHA — Chitwan's tourist hub. Check into jungle guesthouse (NPR 500–1,200). Chitwan National Park is a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
13:00 PM	Lunch. Rest briefly.
14:00 PM	AFTERNOON JEEP SAFARI inside Chitwan National Park (NPR 1,500–2,500 per person). One-horned rhinoceros, Royal Bengal Tiger (rare sighting), elephants, gharial crocodiles, spotted deer, over 500 bird species. Highly recommended.
16:30 PM	RAPTI RIVER SUNSET WALK along the river bank — birds, crocodiles basking on banks, beautiful golden light on the Terai jungle.
19:00 PM	THARU CULTURAL SHOW — traditional dance performance of the indigenous Tharu people (Nepal's jungle community). Often included free at guesthouses or NPR 200–300 separate entry.
21:00 PM	Dinner. Sleep to jungle sounds — Chitwan is magical at night.

DAY 14 — CHITWAN → LUMBINI (160 km | ~4 hrs | Mahendra Highway)

Time	Activity
08:00 AM	Breakfast + checkout. Fill fuel. Start ride west on MAHENDRA HIGHWAY (NH01) — Nepal's main east-west highway. Good road through the Terai plains.
08:30–12:30	Route: Chitwan (Bharatpur) → Narayanghat → Butwal → Bhairahawa → Lumbini (160 km, ~4 hrs). Mahendra Highway is well-maintained. Bhairahawa is a large border town (Sunauli border is here).
12:30 PM	Arrive LUMBINI — birthplace of Lord Gautama Buddha. Check into guesthouse or dharamshala (NPR 400–900). UNESCO World Heritage Site.
13:30 PM	MAYA DEVI TEMPLE — built exactly over the ancient sacred spot where Queen Maya Devi gave birth to Siddhartha Gautama (later the Buddha). The marker stone inside is 3rd century BC. Serene and deeply moving. Free entry.
14:30 PM	ASHOKAN PILLAR — Emperor Ashoka's personal pillar from the 3rd century BC. His inscription confirms this as Buddha's birthplace. One of the oldest inscriptions in South Asia.
15:00 PM	SACRED GARDEN — Puskarni Pond where Maya Devi bathed before giving birth. Peaceful, shaded walking area. Free entry.
15:30 PM	MONASTIC ZONE — ride or walk through the vast zone of monasteries built by different countries in honour of Buddha's birthplace. India, China, Myanmar, Thailand, Sri Lanka, Japan, Korea, Germany, USA — each has a unique monastery. Unlike anywhere else in the world.
19:00 PM	Dinner at Lumbini market. Peaceful evening — Lumbini is far less crowded than Kathmandu. Lovely night walk around the Sacred Garden.

NOTE: Lumbini's monastic zone is extraordinary — you can ride your motorcycle slowly through it as the roads are wide and quiet. The contrast of seeing how 20+ different countries have interpreted Buddhist architecture side by side is fascinating. Best photography light is late afternoon. Entry to most areas is free.

DAY 15 — LUMBINI → SUNAULI/RAXAUL BORDER → BIHAR (Return to India)

Time	Activity
07:00 AM	Breakfast + checkout Lumbini. Fill Nepal fuel one last time (Nepal fuel is comparable quality to India).
08:00 AM	Ride Lumbini → Bhairahawa → SUNAULI BORDER (30 km, 45 min). Sunauli border (closer from Lumbini) is the Nepal exit point; the India side is Sunauli, Uttar Pradesh.
08:45 AM	NEPAL EXIT at Sunauli — exit stamp on passport. Cancel your Bhansar vehicle permit at Nepal customs (important — hand back the permit or confirm cancellation).
09:15 AM	INDIA ENTRY at Sunauli (UP side) — entry stamp. Now you are back in India. Ride east toward Bihar.
09:30 AM	Fill fuel on India side (cheaper than Nepal). Route: Sunauli → Gorakhpur (UP, 90 km) → continue east into Bihar via NH27/NH28.
15:00–17:00	Arrive BIHAR HOME. Trip complete — celebrate with family!
Evening	Rest well. Give the bike a full inspection before the return parcel shipment. Note any mechanical issues for servicing.

NOTE: BORDER CHOICE: Sunauli border (near Bhairahawa) is closer from Lumbini and faster to process. If your Bihar home is in East Champaran / Muzaffarpur district, consider returning via Raxaul instead (Lumbini → Birgunj → Raxaul border, ~250 km, 6 hrs). Both are straightforward crossings.

DAYS 16–17 (BUFFER) — BIHAR REST + BIKE SERVICE + PARCEL BOOKING

Activity	Details
Full bike service	Engine oil change, chain clean + lubrication, brake inspection, tyre check, coolant level, all lights tested. Either DIY or at a local mechanic in Bihar.
Rest and recovery	12+ days of mountain riding is physically demanding. Eat well at home, sleep fully, let your body recover before the long train journey back.
Book return parcel	Go to Bihar railway station parcel office. Book return bike parcel to Mumbai CST/LTT. Drain fuel again. Get consignment receipt. Choose a train you will be on.
Document preservation	Safely store all your Nepal permits, Bhansar documents, ACAP permit — these are proof of your achievement and useful for any future Nepal trip.

DAYS 18–19 — BIHAR → MUMBAI (Train) | ARRIVE MUMBAI

Day	Activity
Day 18	Submit bike at Bihar station parcel office in the morning. Board your train to Mumbai — 12141 PATNA SF EXPRESS or 12397 MAHABODHI EXPRESS. SL class Rs.500–700. ~24–26 hrs journey.
Day 19	Arrive Mumbai. Collect bike from LTT/CST parcel office. YATRA COMPLETE — you have visited Pashupatinath (Kathmandu), Muktinath Dham, Chitwan, Lumbini, and explored Nepal end to end by motorcycle!

DAY 20 — BUFFER DAY (Emergency Reserve)

Day 20 is your emergency reserve. Use it if any day in the trip was delayed due to weather, road closure, illness, or mechanical breakdown. If the trip runs smoothly as planned and you are back in Mumbai on Day 19, Day 20 is your rest/recovery day before returning to work. Always plan with a buffer — mountain trips rarely go perfectly to schedule, and that is part of the adventure.

COMPLETE NEPAL SIGHTSEEING REFERENCE GUIDE

KATHMANDU — Don't Miss These

Place	Distance / How	Entry Fee	Significance
Pashupatinath Temple	5 km from Thamel, bike	Free (Hindus)	Most sacred Shiva temple in Nepal — Bagmati Ghats — powerful cremation ceremony
Boudhanath Stupa	8 km from Thamel, bike	NPR 400	UNESCO — largest stupa in Asia — major Tibetan Buddhist centre
Swayambhunath (Monkey Temple)	3 km west, bike + 365 steps	NPR 200	Hilltop stupa with panoramic Kathmandu valley view — very photogenic
Kathmandu Durbar Square	City centre, bike + walk	NPR 1,000	UNESCO — medieval palace, Kumari Ghar (living goddess), Taleju Temple
Bhaktapur Durbar Square	13 km east, 30 min ride	NPR 1,800	UNESCO — best preserved medieval town — 55-Window Palace, Nyatapola pagoda
Patan (Lalitpur) Durbar Square	6 km south, 15 min ride	NPR 1,000	UNESCO — finest Newari stone architecture — Krishna Mandir, Golden Temple
Nagarkot Viewpoint	32 km east, 45 min ride	Free	Best Himalaya panorama near Kathmandu — Everest, Langtang visible on clear days
Changu Narayan Temple	22 km east, 35 min ride	NPR 300	Oldest temple in Nepal (5th century AD) — UNESCO — intricate wood carving

POKHARA — Nepal's Adventure and Spiritual Hub

Place	Distance / How	Cost	Significance
Sarangkot Viewpoint	8 km, 30 min ride up	Free	Best sunrise Himalaya panorama — Annapurna, Machhapuchhre, Dhaulagiri all visible
Fewa Lake + Barahi Temple	Lakeside, rowboat	Boat NPR 300/hr	Iconic lake with island temple — Annapurna range reflection in the water
Davis Falls (Patale Chhango)	2 km from lake, bike	NPR 50	Unique waterfall that disappears underground — beautiful in Oct
Gupteshwor Mahadev Cave	Adjacent to Davis Falls	NPR 100	Natural cave with ancient Shiva lingam — sacred and geologically fascinating
World Peace Pagoda	3 km + hill walk or ride	Free	White Buddhist stupa — 360-degree view of lake, city, and Annapurna range
Mahendra Cave / Bat Cave	8 km north, bike	NPR 100–200	Natural limestone cave — large fruit bat colony — interesting formations
International Mountain Museum	2 km from lake, bike	NPR 300	History of 8,000m peak expeditions — climbing gear museum — highly educational
Paragliding at Sarangkot	8 km, organised tour	Rs.3,000–4,000	World-class paragliding over Fewa Lake and Himalayas — 20–30 min flight

MUKTINATH ROUTE — Key Stops (Pokhara to Muktinath)

Place	Altitude	Distance from Previous	Why Stop Here
Nayapul / Birethanti	1,070m	42 km from Pokhara	ACAP entry checkpoint — Annapurna zone begins — first dramatic mountain scenery
Tatopani	1,189m	~100 km from Pokhara	Natural geothermal hot springs in sulphur pools — MUST stop — soak and restore
Ghasa	2,010m	30 km from Tatopani	Magar and Thakali village — traditional houses — good altitude acclimatization night
Kalopani	2,530m	20 km from Ghasa	Best simultaneous view of Dhaulagiri (8,167m) and Annapurna I (8,091m) — stop for photos
Marpha	2,670m	8 km from Kalopani	Famous apple orchards and apple brandy — UNESCO-listed ancient Thakali village
Jomsom	2,720m	8 km from Marpha	Base for Muktinath. District HQ. ATM. Airport. Strong afternoon winds — arrive by noon.
Kagbeni	2,810m	8 km from Jomsom	Medieval mud-brick fortress village — gateway to Upper Mustang — Black Kali temple
MUKTINATH DHAM	3,710m	14 km from Jomsom	108 sacred water spouts — Vishnu Temple (Divya Desam) — Jwala Mai — Buddhist Gompa

NOTE: Upper Mustang (Lo Manthang, the ancient walled city) requires a special Restricted Area Permit (RAP) — USD 500 for 10 days. Not included in this itinerary but accessible from Jomsom if budget and time allow. The landscape of Upper Mustang (desert Himalayas) is unlike anywhere else.

CHITWAN NATIONAL PARK + LUMBINI

Place	Activity	Cost (approx)	Why Visit
Chitwan — Jeep Safari	Wildlife drive inside park	NPR 1,500–2,500	One-horned rhino, Royal Bengal Tiger, elephant, gharial crocodile — all in one park
Chitwan — Canoe + Nature Walk	River canoe + guided jungle walk	NPR 500–800	Intimate experience — birds, gharial, peaceful jungle — great photography
Tharu Cultural Show	Evening traditional dance	Free–NPR 300	Indigenous Tharu community — unique leopard dance and stick dances
Rapti River Sunset Walk	Walking along river bank	Free	Crocodiles, birds, golden sunset light on the Terai forest — serene
Lumbini — Maya Devi Temple	Pilgrimage darshan	Free	Exact birthplace of Lord Buddha — ancient marker stone — UNESCO
Lumbini — Ashokan Pillar	History + archaeology	Free	Emperor Ashoka's 3rd century BC inscription confirming this as Buddha's birthplace
Lumbini — Monastic Zone	Walk or ride through	Free	20+ countries' monasteries in one zone — architectural diversity — unique in world
Lumbini — Sacred Garden	Peaceful walk	Free	Puskarni Pond (Maya Devi's bathing pond) — serene garden meditation area

COMPLETE PACKING LIST — NEPAL MOTORCYCLE YATRA

Motorcycle + Riding Gear (Non-Negotiable Safety Items)

- Full-face helmet — MANDATORY in Nepal, checked at police checkpoints on all highways
- Riding jacket with CE-rated armour pads (shoulder, elbow, back) — mountain winds are cold and crash protection is essential
- Riding gloves — full-finger, wind-proof. Cold even in October above 2,500m altitude
- Riding pants with knee/hip armour, or reinforced jeans with separate knee guards
- Ankle-support riding boots or sturdy high-ankle trekking shoes — NO chappals / sandals for riding
- Goggles or full-face visor — Kali Gandaki valley dust and wind are extreme
- High-visibility vest — wear during low-light conditions and mountain fog
- Waterproof riding jacket / rain cover — October can still have occasional showers
- Bungee cords (6–8 pieces) — for securing luggage and jerrycan to bike
- Basic bike toolkit — adjustable spanner, screwdrivers, Allen keys, zip ties, duct tape
- Engine oil (600 ml extra — your bike's specific grade)
- Spare spark plug (your bike's exact type)
- Tyre puncture kit — tubeless sealant spray + repair plug kit for inner-tube tyres
- 2-litre metal jerry can for extra fuel — essential after Tatopani toward Jomsom
- Chain lube spray — apply every 300–400 km on mountain roads
- Waterproof tank bag or hard saddle bags — keep documents and valuables waterproof
- Phone mount on handlebar + USB charging cable for navigation (offline Google Maps / Maps.me)

Clothing — Layer System (Sea Level to 3,710m Altitude)

- 2 cotton kurtas (MANDATORY for all temple darshans — wear kurta, not t-shirt, at Pashupatinath and Muktinath)
- 2 sets of thermal base layers (top + bottom) — essential for Jomsom (5–10°C nights) and Muktinath (0–8°C)
- 1 heavy down jacket OR thick fleece jacket (buy in Thamel if you do not own one — NPR 800–2,000 for good quality)
- 1 medium layer — zip-up hoodie or light fleece vest for Pokhara/Kathmandu evenings
- 2 regular t-shirts + 1 collared shirt for non-riding days
- 2 pairs trekking/cargo trousers — quick-dry fabric preferred
- Lightweight waterproof outer shell / windbreaker
- 3–4 pairs of socks — include at least 2 pairs wool socks for high altitude cold
- Warm wool cap / balaclava — mandatory for Muktinath ride at 3,710m
- Neck gaiter / scarf
- Flip-flops / rubber sandals — for guesthouses and hot springs at Tatopani
- Small quick-dry personal towel (many dharamshalas do not provide towels)
- 2 extra sets of clothes specifically for Muktinath 108 spouts ritual — you will be completely soaked

Health + Safety Kit

- Altitude sickness medication — Diamox (Acetazolamide) 250mg. Consult your doctor before travel. Begin 24 hrs before ascending above 2,500m. Standard dose: 250mg twice daily.
- Paracetamol 500mg + Ibuprofen 400mg — for headache, body pain, fever
- ORS sachets (15–20 packets) — Electrolyte rehydration, critical at altitude where dehydration happens faster
- Antacid tablets (Digene / Pan 40) — mountain food can upset stomach
- Anti-diarrhoea tablets (Norflox-TZ / Loperamide) — traveller's diarrhoea is very common in Nepal
- Antiseptic cream (Betadine / Savlon) + waterproof bandages, cotton, safety pins
- Personal prescription medicines — carry DOUBLE the required quantity in case of extension
- Sunscreen SPF 50+ (apply generously — UV radiation is severely intense at 3,710m altitude)
- Lip balm with SPF — high-altitude wind and UV causes severe lip cracking
- Eye drops (Systane / clear lubricant) — Kali Gandaki dust is brutal on eyes even with visor
- Insect repellent (DEET-based) — essential for Chitwan jungle safari and Lumbini evenings
- Small first aid reference card

Tech + Navigation + Money

- Smartphone (primary navigation) — download Google Maps OFFLINE for Nepal + Maps.me Nepal map BEFORE leaving India
- Powerbank 20,000 mAh — many mountain guesthouses have erratic power, some have no charging at night
- Universal travel adapter + 2-in-1 USB charging cable
- Nepal SIM card — buy NTC (Nepal Telecom) or Ncell SIM at Birgunj or Kathmandu. Cost NPR 200 with data.
- Indian SIM — keep it active for Bihar legs of the journey
- Action camera (GoPro / Insta360) — optional but the Himalayan riding footage will be incredible
- WhatsApp — share your live location with a family member every evening without fail
- NPR cash — carry NPR 20,000–25,000 (~Rs.12,500–16,000). Exchange at Birgunj border (best rates).
- INR Rs.8,000–10,000 emergency cash — keep HIDDEN in inner pocket or sock, separate from wallet
- ATMs available at: Kathmandu, Pokhara, Jomsom (sometimes unreliable). Inform your bank before travelling.
- UPI (Google Pay / PhonePe) — works at most Kathmandu and Pokhara shops. NOT reliable in mountain areas.
- Physical notebook + pen — write your daily plan; useful when phone battery is low

Food + Trail Supplies

- Energy bars / protein bars (15–20 pieces) — for long mountain riding stretches between meals
- Dry fruits mix — cashews, almonds, raisins, walnuts (500g) — high energy, zero spoilage, perfect trail food
- Glucose biscuits + digestive biscuits (3–4 packs)
- Homemade achar / pickle from Bihar home — morale booster on tough days!
- Instant coffee sachets or green tea bags — mountain mornings need a hot drink
- Electrolyte / ORS powder sachets — mix with water at altitude to prevent dehydration
- Water purification tablets as backup — for mountain stream or uncertain water sources
- 2-litre reusable water bottle — stay hydrated at altitude (drink minimum 3 litres per day above 3,000m)
- Eat vegetarian throughout the yatra — easier for temple entry, stomach health, and budget
- Dal Bhat thali is your best friend in Nepal — NPR 200–400, unlimited refills, completely vegetarian option available

COMPLETE BUDGET ESTIMATE — NEPAL MOTORCYCLE YATRA (20 DAYS)

Expense Head	Details	Estimated Cost (INR)
Train: Mumbai ↔ Bihar (×2, SL class)	LTT/CST → Patna or Gaya + return. Book 60 days early on IRCTC. SL class recommended.	Rs.1,000 – 1,400
Bike parcel: Mumbai ↔ Bihar (×2 shipments)	Indian Railways parcel service. Confirm rates at parcel office before booking.	Rs.4,000 – 7,000
Nepal Bhansar permit for motorcycle	NPR 150/day × ~13 days in Nepal (~Rs.93/day). Online application preferred.	Rs.1,200 – 1,500
ACAP Permit (Annapurna Conservation Area)	NPR 3,000 one-time. Collect from NTB office in Kathmandu or Pokhara.	Rs.1,860
Fuel — India + Nepal circuit (~1,600 km total)	~1,200 km in Nepal + ~400 km in India (Bihar to/from Raxaul). Approx 40 km/litre.	Rs.4,000 – 5,500
Accommodation — 13 nights in Nepal	Mix: dharamshalas NPR 400–600/night, guesthouses NPR 700–1,200/night.	Rs.7,000 – 12,000
Accommodation — 2 nights Bihar	At home — no cost.	Rs.0 (Home)
Food — all 20 days	Rs.300–400/day in India. NPR 400–600/day dal bhat in Nepal.	Rs.6,000 – 8,000
Kathmandu sightseeing entry fees	Bhaktapur NPR 1,800 + Patan NPR 1,000 + Boudhanath NPR 400 + others.	Rs.3,000 – 4,000
Chitwan National Park safari	Jeep safari NPR 1,500–2,500 + canoe + cultural show.	Rs.1,500 – 2,500
Pokhara activities (optional)	Paragliding Rs.3,000–4,000 / boat hire / cave entries.	Rs.1,500 – 3,500
Muktinath rituals + temple donations	108 spouts entry + prasad + various temple donations across Nepal.	Rs.1,000 – 1,500
Health + Safety (medicines, sunscreen, etc.)	Diamox, first aid, sunscreen, ORS, extra medicines.	Rs.1,000 – 1,500
Emergency / Contingency (10% buffer)	Weather delays, extra night, mechanical repair, unexpected costs.	Rs.2,000 – 3,500
GRAND TOTAL — All Inclusive (20 Days)	Mumbai → Bihar → Nepal → Bihar → Mumbai. Complete round trip.	Rs.35,060 – 53,260

NOTE: Budget above is for solo rider carrying own bike from Mumbai via train parcel (both ways). Bike parcel cost varies by train and distance — confirm current rates at the railway parcel office. In Nepal, 1 INR = approx 1.6 NPR — carry NPR 20,000–25,000 (~Rs.12,500–16,000) and top up at Kathmandu or Pokhara ATMs. Dal Bhat thali is the best value meal anywhere in Nepal — NPR 200–400 with unlimited refills. Grand total range covers a comfortable budget trip — actual spending will be closer to the lower estimate if you stick to dharamshalas and dal bhat.

ESSENTIAL TIPS — SAFE AND SUCCESSFUL YATRA

Topic	Guidance
Altitude Acclimatization	Muktinath is at 3,710m. Ascend gradually — spend a night at Jomsom (2,720m) before riding to Muktinath. If you experience severe headache, vomiting, or confusion, descend immediately to Jomsom. Never ignore acute mountain sickness (AMS) symptoms. Diamox 250mg taken 24 hrs before ascent significantly helps. Drink 3–4 litres of water daily above 3,000m.
Kali Gandaki Afternoon Winds	Winds in the Kali Gandaki gorge (world's deepest gorge) regularly reach 60–80 km/h after 12 PM. ALWAYS complete your riding in this zone by 12:30 PM. The rule is simple: ride in the morning, rest in the afternoon. Morning is always calm and beautiful. Keeping your helmet visor completely down is essential even in the morning in this valley.
Fuel Management	Petrol stations are available until Tatopani comfortably. After Tatopani toward Jomsom, stations become sparse. Carry 2 litres extra in a jerry can. Fill up at every opportunity — Baglung, Beni, Tatopani, Jomsom. Nepal petrol quality is perfectly fine for your Royal Enfield.
Nepal Police Checkpoints	Multiple checkpoints on all major Nepal highways — Prithvi Highway, Pokhara-Beni road, and Jomsom road each have several. Always stop completely, remove helmet, be polite. Keep your DL + Passport + Bhansar permit in your front jacket pocket for quick access — do not bury them in your rucksack.
Temple Etiquette	Remove footwear and ALL leather items (belt, wallet, jacket) at all temple entrances. Wear kurta (not t-shirt) for Pashupatinath and Muktinath darshan. No photography inside sanctum sanctorum. Maintain silence near the deity. Offerings of flowers, coconut, and incense are appreciated.
Solo Safety Protocol	Share live Google Maps location with a family member every single evening. Text or call every night. Tell your guesthouse owner your next day's route and destination every morning. At ACAP checkpoints, you are registered — this is a safety net. Trust your instincts — Nepal is generally very safe for solo travelers.
Bike Security in Nepal	Park bike in the guesthouse courtyard or visible indoor parking wherever available. Use a disc lock at night. Carry only your sling bag into temples — leave rucksack locked on bike or at guesthouse. Nepal is generally a very safe country but basic precautions are always wise.
Cash vs UPI in Nepal	UPI (Google Pay, PhonePe) works widely in Kathmandu and Pokhara markets and restaurants. Once you enter the mountain zone (Beni and beyond), it is CASH ONLY. Always carry minimum NPR 5,000 on your person. ATMs: NIC Asia, Nabil Bank, Everest Bank work reliably with Indian debit/credit cards.
Food Safety	Nepal is excellent for vegetarians — dal bhat thali is available everywhere at low cost. Avoid raw salads and unpeeled fruits in mountain areas. Stick to hot, freshly cooked food. Drink only bottled or boiled water. The biggest stomach risk is cold salads or re-heated food in busy tourist restaurants.
Train Booking (India)	Book both the Mumbai-Bihar and Bihar-Mumbai train tickets 60 days in advance on IRCTC app. For bike parcel: visit the originating station's parcel office on the day of travel or 1–2 days early. GNWL quota cancels and confirms well — do not panic about waitlisted tickets.
Weather Backup Plan	If weather unexpectedly closes the Muktinath road (rare in October but possible), helicopter service operates Pokhara → Jomsom → Muktinath. One-way helicopter: USD 100–160 per person. Your bike can stay safely at Pokhara guesthouse while you fly. Book through any Pokhara travel agency or directly with Simrik Air / Sita Air.

OM NAMAH SHIVAYA | JAI MUKTINATH BHAGWAN

JAI PASHUPATINATH | OM MANI PADME HUM | JAI MAHADEV

May Lord Shiva bless your journey through the sacred Himalayas.

May Lord Vishnu of Muktinath grant liberation and moksha to you and your ancestors.

May you complete this Moto Yatra safely, with joy and devotion, and return home blessed.

Har Har Mahadev! Om Namah Shivaya! Safe Riding! Jai Muktinath!

Prepared for: Samaranjan Pankajkumar Manjhi | Age 27 | Bihar → Mumbai → Nepal Moto Yatra 2027 | Prepared by: Samaranjan Pankajkumar Manjhi